

NAVIGATING THESIS WRITING WITH AI

CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION (THE PROBLEM)

The Challenge: Writing an English undergraduate thesis is highly difficult, demanding critical thinking and high-quality writing skills.

Student Roadblocks: Undergraduate EFL students frequently face severe hurdles, including:

- Limited vocabulary and grammar/punctuation confusion.
- Trouble developing paragraphs and determining research topics.
- Mental blocks when attempting to paraphrase academic theories.

Impact: Students feel completely stuck, anxious, and experience thought barriers that make the writing process highly inefficient.

CHAPTER 2: LITERATURE REVIEW (CURRENT SOLUTIONS)

The Educational Shift: Artificial Intelligence Applications in Education (AIEd)—such as chatbots and digital writing tools—are increasingly being utilized to improve learning and research.

The Student AI Toolkit: Students actively map specific AI applications to solve unique writing challenges:

- **Ideation & Brainstorming:** ChatGPT and Bard to seek inspiration, create background drafts, and discuss ideas.
- **Paraphrasing & Syntax:** QuillBot to rewrite sentences without copy-pasting, and Grammarly to verify grammar.
- **Literature Search:** Elicit, Perplexity, and Google Scholar to find relevant research journals and references.

CHAPTER 3: METHODOLOGY (THE STEP-BY-STEP PLAN)

Research Design: A qualitative approach using a transcendental phenomenological design to deeply explore students' views and interactions with AI.

Participants: 6 English Language Education undergraduate students who voluntarily agreed to participate.

The 4-Stage Moustakas Data Analysis Plan:

1. **Epoche (Bracketing):** The researchers set aside all personal opinions, assumptions, and biases to view the data cleanly.
2. **Phenomenological Reduction:** Transcribing the 30-minute interviews, eliminating irrelevant or overlapping answers, and grouping key statements into themes.
3. **Imaginative Variations:** Shifting structural themes from textural descriptions to understand how the experience influenced the students.
4. **Textural-Structural Synthesis:** Combining what the students experienced with how they experienced it to find the true essence of the phenomenon.

CHAPTER 4: IMPLEMENTATION/RESULTS (THE DATA)

The research uncovered three distinct themes highlighting the positive impact of AI integration:

Theme 1: Elevated Motivation: Real-time, rapid AI feedback provides a sense of accomplishment, encouraging students to develop critical and creative thinking.

Theme 2: Problem-Solving Decision Making: Students use AI tools strategically to overcome grammar confusion, locate relevant journals, and bypass thought blocks.

Theme 3: Shifting Academic Attitudes: Participants experienced a powerful psychological evolution—moving from initial hesitation and skepticism to comfort, confidence, and self-assurance.

CHAPTER 5: CONCLUSION (THE FINAL IMPACT)

The Verdict: When students understand the limitations of AI, it serves as a highly beneficial, essential tool that alters academic culture for the better. It directly reduces writing anxiety, strengthens critical analysis, and builds student confidence.

Future Horizon: Because this study focused on immediate experiences, further research is strongly required to grasp the long-term impacts of AI across higher education as a whole.

